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Peking April 30th
Mr. Wade
No. 72
—
16 Enclosures
—
Rec. July 21.
—
Japanese Expedition to Formosa.

The Queen
Mr Disraeli
circulate

Ly. approve
July 23

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716

Peking, 30th April, 1874.

172.

My Lord,

My Telegram of the 24th instant will have informed Your Lordship that Sir H. Parkes had sent me a message regarding an expedition about to leave Japan for Formosa I have now the honor to forward copies of

The Earl of Derby.

&c. &c. &c.

2

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of various papers on the same subject.

The German Legation was the first here to receive the news. A telegram reached it on the 10th instant. That addressed to me, coming by a different steamer from Shanghai, only reached me on the 15th.

I inclose copy of it.

The

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The Emperor of China had left Peking a few days previously for the Western Tombs of the Dynasty, accompanied by all but three of the Ministers of the Yamên, and these three having gone out to meet his Majesty on his return, it was not until the 18th that I succeeded in making

Any

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Any Communication on the subject to the Yamên.

On the 18th, Mr. Mayers, the Chinese Secretary, proceeded to the Yamên with a Memorandum (Inclosure 2), of instructions in accordance with which he endeavoured to obtain such answers to the questions suggested by Sir Harry Parkes's message as

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as would enable me to inform him of the view taken by the Chinese — Government of the expedition.

Mr. Mayers was received by the Minister Tung Hsün, President of the Board of Revenue. I enclose Memorandum of the interview, from which it will be seen that the President Tung admitted no knowledge of the expedition.

3

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expedition. He opined that the territory was beyond doubt Chinese; on the view his Government might take of the — expedition, he wished to consult his colleagues.

To prevent loss of time, I at once wrote a note to the President Tung (Inclosure 11), repeating briefly the matter of my instructions to Mr. Mayers

And

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and begging for an early reply to the questions he had been directed to ask.

On the 19th, I received a second telegram from Sir Harry Parkes, copy of which I enclose, and it was not till late on the 20th that a reply to my Note of the 18th to the President Tsung arrived. I inclose translation of this

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this which, it will be seen,
leans in the name of all
the Ministers collectively.
They thank me for my
solicitude. They deny that
the expedition was spoken
of, — the phrase is rather,
"formally brought forward," —
by the Japanese either
last year or since. They
assert that the territory
occupied by the Formosan
Aborigines

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Aborigines is incontestably Chinese, and declining to revert to the President Tung's admissions to Mr Mayers regarding enforcement of neutrality, they beg me to decide in what form I should reply to Sir Harry Parkes.

Next morning, 21st instant, I telegraphed accordingly to Sir Harry Parkes.

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Parkes (Inclosure 4) that the Chinese had no knowledge of the expedition, but did claim sovereignty over the country apparently about to be invaded.

As Sir Harry Parkes had mentioned that the Japanese were writing to Hongkong as well as

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as Shanghai for ships and pilots, I sent Sir Arthur Kennedy, Governor of Hongkong, a duplicate of the above telegram with a request that he would inform the Admiral Sir Charles Shadwell, who, I knew, was either at Hongkong or in the neighbourhood.

I had the day before written to Sir Charles Shadwell (Inclosure 8.) to the effect that though the Japanese appeared

to

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to me to be committing what
we should regard, were the
territory ours, as an act
of war, I thought immediate
collision between China
and Japan improbable; also
that the ports of Tawan and
Tamsui were at such a
distance from the point of
debarkation, that I was not
alarmed for the safety of
British subjects at these.
Still I requested the Admiral
to

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to take them under his special protection.

Sir Harry Parkes's desire has been manifestly to prevent British subjects from committing a breach of neutrality by engaging in the service of the Japanese Government, which was understood to be taking up ships and engaging pilots to assist its operations. I sympathise with

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with this desire, and
should consider myself
equally bound to restrain
British subjects from taking
service on the side of China
as against Japan, were
there a declaration of war.
This as yet there is not,
on the reverse whatever
the real purpose of the
Japanese, and however firm
the conviction of foreigners.
myself included, that they
are going further than
at

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at present they admit, all
that they do admit at present
is that they are sending a
sort of armed commission
of inquiry to Formosa, and
they disclaim hostile intentions
as against China. This is
shewn by a Telegram from
Japan to the Japanese Consul
at Shanghai, Copy of which
(Inclosure 9) M. de Halleben,
Chargé d'Affaires of Germany,
received yesterday afternoon
and was so good as to
Communicate

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Communicate to me. I append the text of it.

Sir Harry Parkes also mentions in his second Telegram (Inclosure 5) that a Japanese Minister is on the point of leaving Yedo for China. It is curious that although the Ministers of the Yamên declare that they know nothing of this Mission, preparations are being made

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made at this moment for its reception at Teintsin whatever this may mean, the Japanese, if they are sending a Minister here, evidently propose to maintain as long as it may be possible, that there is no rupture with China.

This, on the other part, is a statement of the Case that, I believe, will be very acceptable to the Chinese, who

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who are quite unprepared for war except behind fortifications at a few given points, and who would at all times rather trust to luck and Compromise than resort to war.

I have deemed it therefore my duty to instruct Her Majesty's Consuls at Shanghai, Canton, Taiwan and Tamsui, these being the ports more particularly likely to

be

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be Concerned, to abstain from all public notices on the subject of this expedition, as these might possibly be taken to anticipate the declaration of war, which neither of the parties immediately interested has seen fit to make; but to Caution British subjects who, to their Knowledge, may be contemplating service with either party, against acceptance of such engagement.

I

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I inclose copies of the instructions I addressed to Mr. Medhurst (Inclosures 10 and 11.), to Sir Brooke Robertson who had written to me confidentially on receiving the news at Hongkong, and to Mr. Gregory and Mr. Herbert Allen respectively in charge of the Ports of Taiwan and Tamsui.

Lastly to keep myself right with the Government of

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of China, I sent the accompanying Memorandum (Inclosure 14) of the intelligence received, of what I had done, and of my reasons for doing no more, to the Yamên, by the hand of Mr. Mayers, upon the 24th instant. I had originally draughted it in the form of a Despatch to the Prince of Kung, but substituted the present paper, as

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As, in my belief, the Prince would much prefer to abstain from correspondence on the subject. Mr Mayers was to say that if the Prince of Kung wished it, I would write a Despatch. On His Highness's behalf, the Ministers who received Mr Mayers declined a Despach, as I expected they would. They added little to what had earlier been stated.

J

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I shall remark in
conclusion that did we not
exterritorialise China,
I should not, until things
had gone farther, have
thought myself called upon
to draw attention, even so far
as I have done so, to our
obligations to be neutral
in the struggle possibly
ahead of us. Understating
as we do to control our
nationals in these countries,

J

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I do not think I could have done less. I have also thought it my duty to request Sir Edmund Hornby's reconsideration of that part of the Order in Council of the 9th March, 1865, which deals with war and rebellion. As I read the Order, it is more favorable to the Government of Japan than to that of China. But I will reserve what I have to

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to say on this subject for the following Despatch.

I beg to add to the Inclosures already enumerated Copies of a Despatch from Sir Harry Parkes which followed his first Telegram, and of Sir Brooke Robertson's Confidential Despatch above referred to.

I have the honor to be with the highest respect,

My Lord,

Your Lordship's most obedient,

humble servant,

Thomas Francis Wade.

S

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Telegram
Sir H. Barkly
to
Mr. Lowe

—2.—

Enclosure
No 1
in Mr. Lowe's
No 72
of April 30th 1874

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Telegram
Sir H. Parkes
to
Mr. Wade

"Japanese are suddenly dispatching
several ships and two thousand of
more men to Formosa ostensibly
against savages at South point, but
prepared for occupation. Uncertain
whether they will or can avoid
Chinese territory. Important to
inform me immediately of views
and intentions of Chinese Government
as Japanese are engaging foreign
transports. De Gerdre and another
American officer accompany expedition."

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Memorandum

Enclosure
No 2
in Mr. Bruce's
No 42
of April 30th 1874

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Mem: by Mr Wade

Peking
18th April 1874

Sir Harry Parkes has telegraphed to say that the Japanese are sending a large force to Formosa. it is said to land on the South side of the island. in the country of the Aborigines. As it is believed that the Japanese Government is hiring foreign

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foreign vessels to carry these troops, it is the duty of Her Majesty's Representatives, in the interest of neutrality, to enquire:

1st. If that part of the island of Formosa inhabited by the Aborigines is or is not claimed by the Chinese Government as Chinese territory.

2nd. If it be, whether the Chinese

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Chinese Government has consented to allow the Japanese to land a force in that part of Formosa.

3ᵒ. If it be not, whether it is accessible otherwise than through Chinese territory.

4ᵒ. If not otherwise accessible, whether the Chinese Government has consented to allow Japanese troops to pass through

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through Chinese territory.

The Yamên will understand that if the territory occupied by the Aborigines is not regarded by the Chinese Government as Chinese territory, or if, being Chinese territory, the Chinese Government consent to the debarkation of a force within it, or to the passage of Japanese troops through Chinese territory,

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territory to such territory, the British Government will not be obliged to desire British subjects to abstain from serving with or assisting the Japanese; but that, if the case be otherwise, if the Japanese be about to act without the consent and against the wishes of the Chinese Government, it will be necessary to call upon British

//

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British subjects to refrain from serving or assisting either China or Japan in the prosecution of the war.

This because Great Britain has treaties with both powers, and is at peace with both.

(signed) F. J. Wade.

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Memorandum

Enclosure
No 3
in Mr. Burke's
No 42
of April 30th 1874

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Memorandum of visit to Yamên.
April 18th 1874.

On proceeding this afternoon to the Yamên I saw the President of the Board of Revenue, Tung, who listened quite impassively to my communication of the news relating to Japan and Formosa. No intelligence of the intended movements of the Japanese had, he stated, previously reached the Yamên. He recollected something having been said about the savages in Formosa when the Japanese treaty was being negotiated,

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negotiated, but the matter had entirely dropped.

The only positive answer he could return was to the effect that no consent to the proposed landing had been given on the part of China. No notice indeed of the intended movement had been received.

As regards the question of sovereignty, he appeared to be unprepared to give a definite reply. His first statement was that the savage territory, of the whereabouts of which he confessed

his

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his ignorance, is "beyond the limits within which the Chinese exercise the functions of Government, but is not subject to any other power."

He subsequently stated that the whole island of Formosa is undoubtedly looked upon as within the dominions of the Emperor; but that the savages are left to their own devices so long as they do not interfere by acts of aggression with the territory peopled by Chinese. He was quite unable to state whether the Japanese must

necessarily

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necessarily pass through Chinese territory in order to reach the savages; but in such a case he thinks it would be only right of them to give notice to China. In due course, he had no doubt, the Taotai of Formosa will report whatever may take place, to his superiors at Foochow.

His Excellency was aware of the duties of neutrality imposed by international usage; but he was not prepared to say, without consulting his colleagues and the Prince, what would be the

view

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view taken by China of the action attributed to the Japanese.

(signed) W. F. Mayers

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Mr. Wade
to
President Grevy

—o—

Enclosure
No. 4
in Mr. Wade's
No. 92
of April 20th 1874

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4 w 1

Wade to

Peking 18th April 1874.

Mr. Wade presents his compliments to the President Tsung.

The Chinese Secretary Mr. Mayers informs Mr Wade that, in conformity with his instructions, he proceeded this afternoon to the Yamen for the purpose of stating the substance of a Telegram received from Sir H Parkes, regarding an expedition about to be undertaken by the Japanese government against the

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the Aborigines inhabiting the East coast of Formosa.
Mr. Mayers was further instructed to ascertain whether the country inhabited by these people is regarded by the Chinese Government as a constituent portion of the Empire, and, if so, whether the Japanese force about to land there is acting with the knowledge and consent of the Chinese Government.

From the replies of the President to his questions, Mr. Mayers gathered that the

Eastern

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Eastern portion of Formosa is considered by the Chinese Government to form part of the Empire, but His Excellency seemed disposed to consult the Prince of Kung and his colleagues, before giving any answer as to the view that might be taken by the Chinese Government regarding the action of the Japanese.

Sir H. Parkes's telegram has been here three days, but, the Ministers being absent from the Yamen, it has not been in Mr. Wade's power earlier

to

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Eastern

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to

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to consult them.

The matter is of pressing importance, and Mrs. Wade will be greatly obliged to the President Tsung if he will put him in possession of such information as will enable him to telegraph to Sir H. Parkes, at His Excellency's earliest convenience.

(signed) T. F. Wade

Incl 4

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Telegram
Sir A. Parkes
to
Mr Lowe

Enclosure
No 5
in Mr. Lowe's
No 92
of April 30th 1874

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Text of Telegram from Sir H. Parkes
to
Mr. Wade.
received April 16th 1874

Expedition proceeds rapidly assisted by
American officers and transports. Japanese
declare that Formosa from Godonglin
south does not belong to China. Permanent
occupation evidently intended. Will China
permit this? Please inform me immediately
as until I know whether expedition is
opposed by China difficult to prevent
British ships engaging as transports.
Government have sent to Hongkong and Shanghai
for ships and pilots. Force will land at
Langkiaou

16

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"Longtisan and on East Lower fully equip
" for sedileing. Naval force inferior. Jap
" Minister leaves for Peking at end of April
" Other force unless intercepted will proba
" have landed."

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Translation

—2—

Ministers of the Yamen
&
Mr. Wade

—2—

Enclosure
No 6
in Mr. Wade's
No 72
of April 30th 1874

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Note from the Ministers of the Yamên to T. F. Wade Esq. C. B.

Peking April 20. 1874.

The Ministers have received and acquainted themselves with the contents of Mr. Wade's note (of the 18th inst), and feel beyond measure grateful for the kind attention with which he has honoured them.

They

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They have to state in
reply that during the
residence of the Japanese
ambassador Soyeshima
at Peking last year no
proposition was ever
made to the yamên of
an expedition to be
directed toward the
East coast of Formosa
against the aborigines;
neither has any communication
been

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been received in the present instance, to explain the motive of this warlike movement. As to the question of the sovereignty of China over unreclaimed tribes of this description, there are more than one [under the same conditions] and although the people are allowed to follow their

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their own customs, and
no attempt is made to
force them under [Chinese]
laws, yet that the
region they occupy is
decidedly Chinese
territory, the Ministers
of the Yamên feel sure
will be well understood
by Mr. Wade.

They will be glad
if he will form his own
decision

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decision as to the reply to be sent to Sir Harry Parkes. It is unnecessary for them to trouble him with a repetition of the observations already made by one of their number, the President Tsung, in his conversation with Mr. Mayers; and they consequently conclude with an expression of their

/ &

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their wishes for Mr. Wade's continual prosperity.

{ T'ung Chih 13th year.
3rd mo., 5th day. }

Translated by

(Signed) W. J. Mayers.

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Telegram

W. Wade

to

Sir H. Parkes & Sir A. Hornby

—x—

Enclosure

No 7

in Mr. Wade's

No 72

4 April 30th 1874

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Draft of Telegram from Mr. Wade
to
Sir Harry Parkes
and
Sir A. Kennedy

"Pekin. April 21st. I have communicated
"the news from Japan to the Yamen of
"Foreign Affairs. The Ministers reply that
"they have no knowledge of this expedition,
"and that the country inhabited by the
"Savage tribes does belong to China".

To Hongkong —
"please tell the Admiral".

To Japan —
"I have sent this Telegram to Hongkong".

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Mr. Lowe
&
Sir C. Bankhead

Enclosure
No. 8
in Mr. Lowe's
No. 42
of April 30th 1874

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Pekin,
April 20th 1874

Sir,

Your Excellency will have learned at Hong Kong that the Japanese Government is sending a force to Formosa ostensibly to attack the Aborigines. Sir Harry Parkes farther informs me that the island south of a certain point, which I have failed to

Sir R. Alcock K.C.B.

+ + + 20

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to identify, but which I take to be on the East coast, is declared by the Japanese not to be Chinese territory; and that they are sending to Shanghai and Hongkong for ships and pilots.

In answer to my inquiries here, the Ministers of the Yamën of Foreign Affairs inform me that they have no knowledge whatever of the expedition in question, and that the country inhabited by the savages against

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against whom it is directed is Chinese territory.

The proceedings of the Japanese appear to have taken the Chinese Government by surprise, and judging from its usual indisposition to act promptly, I doubt that any action will be attempted, that might prevent the debarkation of the Japanese force.

While therefore it is scarcely possible to regard what is being done by Japan otherwise than as according to

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to our notions an act of war,
some months may elapse before
there is any collision between a
Chinese authority, civil or military,
and the force of Japan.
At the points at which this will
land, even if the territory be as
I conceive it beyond dispute Chinese,
the Chinese Government is not
officially represented. I am not
consequently alarmed for the
safety of British subjects on
the

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the island of Formosa, but I shall be nevertheless obliged to Your Excellency to take the port of Taiwan and Tamsui, especially the former, as much under your protection as may be conveniently possible,

I have the honor to be,

Sir,

Your Excellency's

most obedient humble servant,

(signed) Thomas Francis Wade

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Telegram
Secretaire
de
Legation Cour de Shanghai

Enclosure
No 4
in Mr. Lowder's
No 72
of April 30th 1874

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Yedo. April 4th 1874

No 8 Hiogo.

Japanese Consul
Shanghai

"Government's object in sending
"officers to Formosa is to enquire
"into fact that our people met
"with cruel treatment from Savages
"and to stop recurrence. Nothing
"more. If there is false rumour
"contradict it."

(Sgd) Terashima

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Mr. Lowe
to
Mr. Goldsmid

—2—

Enclosure
No. 10
in Mr. Lowe's
No. 42
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10

Peking, 20 April, 1874.

? 16

idential

Copy.

Sir,

Sir Harry Parkes informs me by telegraph that the Japanese Government is sending a force against the Aborigines of Formosa, which will be landed in a part of the Island that the Japanese do not admit belongs to China. The Chinese Government informs me that it has no knowledge of this expedition, and that the country of the Aborigines does lie

W. H. Medhurst Esq
&c. &c. &c.
Shanghai. 23

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lie in Chinese territory. It is possible and not improbable that the Chinese Government will not readily recognise the fact that it is being made war upon, and it is no business of ours to insist upon the fact. As however we can hardly take any other view of what is occurring, we must regard ships and pilots employed by the Japanese in this expedition as taking part in an operation of war. I am told that they are sending for both to Shanghai, and you will

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will do well to consult the Chief Judge as to the form in which, should you see any likelihood of British subjects being engaged in such operation, they may be most fitly cautioned against acceptance of the engagement.

There is not the slightest occasion, for the present, to disturb persons serving the Chinese Government in the Customs, or otherwise as civilians in China, and until I am more fully informed

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informed I had rather
that no notification were
issued on the subject.

Your obedient servant,

(Signed) Thomas Francis Wade.

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Mr. Brade
to
Mr. Mulhuser

Enclosure
No. 11
in Mr. Brade's
No. 72
of April. 30th 1874

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Peking. 22nd April, 1874.

F.O. 17

Confidential

Copy.

Sir,

I beg to refer you to my Despatch No. 16 of the 20th inst., at the close of which I say that I had rather no notification was issued regarding the Japanese expedition to Formosa.

I should have spoken more positively. It is our duty to see that by no act of ours we precipitate a declaration of war. For the present

W. H. Medhurst Esq
&c. &c. &c.
Shanghai

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present neither China nor Japan seems disposed to admit that the one power is at war with the other. While cautioning British subjects, therefore, whom you believe to be about to connect themselves with this expedition, against acceptance of service with it, you will be careful to issue no notification on the subject without express instructions from myself.

Your obedient servant,
(Signed) Thomas Francis Wade.

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Mr. Lowder
to
Sir D. B. Robertson

Enclosure
No 12
in Mr. Lowder's
No 72
of April 30th 1874

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Peking.
April 22. 1874

Sir,

I am in receipt of your dispatch, separate and confidential of the 6th Inst, relating to the Japanese Expedition to Formosa. I had already received a telegram from Sir H. Parkes to the effect that the Japanese Government denies the right of the Government of China to claim the Island of Formosa

Sir O. B. Robertson Wr

+ + + 96

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Formosa as its territory south of a certain point which I am unable to identify. In other words the contention of Japan will be that the savage tribes against whom the Japanese force is ostensibly proceeding, do not occupy ground within the limits of this Empire. In reply to my questions the Ministers of the Yamên affirm that they have no knowledge of this Expedition, and that the territory inhabited by the

tribes

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tribes in question, although China does not impose upon them either her laws or usages, is unquestionably Chinese territory. Still there is not on either side a declaration of war and so far as I can see there is not at present any disposition to declare war. As I learn, however, from Sir Harry Parkes that the Japanese are sending to Shanghai for steamers and pilots, I have instructed Mr. Medhurst to

Caution

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caution any British Subjects, who, to his knowledge, may be about to take service with the Japanese, against acceptance of any such engagements. Without express instruction from me, he will not issue any public notice on the subject as it is our duty to take no steps that will precipitate a declaration of war.

I have to request your attention to the same consideration.

(Signed) J. F. Wade.

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Mr. Lowder
to
H. M's Consuls
in Taiwan and Tamsui

Enclosure
No. 13
in Mr. Lowder's
No. 42
of April 30th 1874

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Peking
April 29th 1874

Sir.

News till more than probably have reached You of an expedition from Japan directed against the Aborigines in those parts of Formosa in which the Chinese have no official establishment. I have reason to believe that the Japanese regard or affect to regard the country in question as without the limits of Chinese territory. On the other part I think it likely that the Chinese Govt will be in no hurry to look upon the proceedings of the Japanese

in Schools
in a Sanctuary

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Japanese acts of war against the Chinese Empire. The Japanese fleet will meanwhile land at Langkiao and at some point on the Eastern coast of Formosa.

I do not exceedingly therefore that there will be any movement on the part of the Chinese or Japanese calculated to endanger the safety of British subjects in Formosa but I have written to request Sir Charles Shadwell to take them under his particular care, and I have to instruct you without making public the precise terms of this despatch to do your best to reassure the community as your ports should be

find

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find it alarmed by rumors.

As to acceptance of service on either side there is no declaration of war and we must be careful to issue no notification that might precipitate one, but in the event of your learning that British subjects are about to engage either in the service of Japan apparently as against the Aborigines, or in the service of China apparently as against the Japanese, you will caution them against the hazardous of any such engagement.

(Signed) H. F. Wade

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Memorandum

Enclosure
No 14
in Mr. Lowdes
No 42
of April 20th 1874

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Mem°

Peking.
24. April 1874

With reference to the expedition which the Japanese Government is reported to be sending against the aborigines of Formosa I think it desirable to place on record officially the action I have taken in relation to this matter.

News of this expedition had reached me about the 11th Inst. but owing to the delay of the steamer upon the Bar outside Taku a telegram which Sir Harry Parkes had sent me did not arrive

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arrive here until some days later. On receipt of this I sent to the Yamên to say that I would call there, and in effect I had left the Legation for this purpose on the afternoon of the 16th Inst, when I received an answer to my message, that none of the ministers would be at the Yamên until the following day. On that day the 17th M. Mayers the Chinese Secretary was about to start for the Yamên but as I was again informed that there would be no Ministers there I was obliged to defer my

message

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message. It was not therefore until the 18th Inst, that I was enabled to communicate with any Minister of the Yamên upon the subject of the expedition.

Mr. Mayers was upon that day received by the Ministers Tsung and in accordance with my written instructions copy of which is appended, he explained to his Excellency the state of affairs as shewn by the telegram of Sir Harry Parkes, and requested to be informed of the view taken by the Chinese Government of the action attributed to the Japanese.

Upon

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Upon the last point the President Tsung expressed a desire to consult the Prince of Kung and the rest of the Ministers, and the matter being urgent, I wrote the same evening to His Excellency to beg that no time might be lost.

Upon the 20th I received a note from the Ministers of the Yamên informing me that the Chinese Government had no cognizance of the expedition to Formosa, and that that part of Formosa which the aborigines inhabit is regarded by the Chinese Government

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Government as beyond doubt within its dominions.

In the interim, however, a second telegram had arrived from Sir Harry Parkes informing me that it was affirmed in Japan that no part of Formosa south of a certain point which I have been unable to identify, is Chinese territory; that the equipment of the expedition was proceeding with great rapidity; that the Japanese were sending to Shanghai and HongKong for foreign ships and pilots; that the Japanese force would land

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land both on the east coast and at Lang Kiao; lastly that a Japanese Minister was shortly to leave Japan for China.

It will hence be seen that in respect of the sovereignty of the Island of Formosa, there is a certain conflict between the opinion expressed in the note of the Ministers of the Tsung li Yamên, and the assertion on the part of the Japanese Government referred to in the telegram of Sir Harry Parkes, and in the absence of fuller information as to the nature and objects of the Japanese expedition I have been obliged to confine

myself

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myself to the following measures.

I have telegraphed to Sir Harry Parkes and to Sir Arthur Kennedy, Governor of Hong Kong, who is already in communication on the subject with Sir Harry Parkes, the substance of the Yamen's note of the 20th and I have informed Her Majesty's Consuls at Canton and Shanghai of the news that has reached me from Japan and of the claim of the Chinese Government, as asserted in the note of the Yamên, to the sovereignty of Formosa. But, as the Japanese Government has issued no declaration of war against the Emperor of China and as it is to be inferred from

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from the appointment of a Japanese Minister to China that his Government does not contemplate the issue of any such declaration, and as a Circular notice on the subject might cause it to be inferred that a rupture of relations had already occurred between China & Japan, I have instructed the Consuls in question to put forth no notification regarding this expedition, without express instructions from myself, but in the event of their learning that British subjects are about in any way to accept service with it, to caution them against so engaging themselves.

(Sigd). T. F. Wade.

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Sir H. Parkes
&
Mr. Wade

Enclosure
No. 15
in Mr. Wade's
No. 72
of April 30th 1874

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Yeddo.
April 4th 1874

Sir,

I have the honor to inform you that I have this morning sent you the following telegram in Cypher through Her Consul Kreitner:—

"Japanese are secretly
"despatching several ships and lots
"of troops and more men to Formosa
"ostensibly against savage at-
"South point has prepared for —

reception

J. J. Lowder Esq. C.B.
&c. &c. &c.

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"occupation. Mountain Shelter they
"will or can avoid Chinese territory.
"Important to inform me immediately
"of views and intentions of Chinese
"Government as Japanese are engaging
"Foreign transports. Le Gendre and
"another American officer accompany
"expedition.

You will have learned from
your own communications with the
Ambassador Soyeshima that he
advocated an expedition against
the Aborigines of Formosa on being
told by the Chinese Government
that they could not control the

Natives

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letter, or give redress for the murder
by them Aborigines of Certain ——
Loochoonans. The proposed expedition
was opposed by the Ambassador
Iwakura, when he returned to Japan
in September last and assumed the
charge of the Government, but the present
insurrection seems likely to cause the
Government to think that it was
desirable to engage the attention of
the Samurai or armed class in
military operations of some kind,
and instead of leading them against
Corea. they can attack hostilities with
the Aborigines of Formosa. It remains
to be seen whether such a compromise
will

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will find favour with the Sawmai.

On the 2nd inst. I learned from the Foreign Minister that the reports which has insidiously received circulation that the Government had resolved to undertake an expedition against Jomaa were well founded. He informed me that three ships of war and two battalions numbering from eight hundred to one thousand men has been told off for the purpose, and that the force would be accompanied by a considerable number of followers and by artizans able to make huts and huts. The object of the expedition was to punish the Abrigines who.

had

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has rendered the Loochoonus. and
prevent the commission of similar
outrages in future. either upon Japanese
subjects or on any Foreigners who might
hereafter fall into their hands. He did
not know how long the Expedition would
take, or what degree of permanency
it might acquire; that would
depend upon circumstances. The
Command would be in the hands of
a leading Japanese General named
Saigo (the Younger). and he would be
accompanied by Generals de Seuse
as advisers. They would act upon a
similar plan to that which the

33 Chinese

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Chinese Government recently assaulted
towards them Aborigines when they sent
a force against them, which was also
accompanied by Lieut. L. Senare. It
was proposed that the expedition should
reach Formosa by the head of their wealth.
Dark In my Opening that there
is no harbour in that part of the
island which is occupied by the
Aborigines. The Minister replied that
he believed the force would find an
anchorage suited to their purposes
which is not in Chinese Territory.

I question however, whether
they can find a harbour or —
anchorage and open suited for
a base of operations in territory which
is

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is not Chinese, and it becomes —
important to understand in what
light the Chinese Government regard
this expedition, as Foreigners may at
any time become concerned in it. The
Japanese Government have already
been enquiring upon what terms they
can engage foreign transports, and
I have consequently instructed Her
Majesty's Consuls to warn British
subjects that the conveyance of —
Japanese troops or military stores into
Chinese waters, without the consent
of the Chinese Government previously
obtained, would be an aggression on
the latter Power. I should feel obliged.
therefore if you would inform me
by

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by the earliest opportunity of the
views of the Chinese Government on
the subject, and of the course they
propose to take, in order that I may
know myself and be able to inform
British subjects of the true position of
affairs. I believe that if the present
expedition succeeds in securing a
footing, it will be followed by a large
force of the unemployed Samurai
and that the occupation of the Corea
if Formosa as they can take, will
follow. It is given out that one of
their first objects is the erection of a
light-house at South Cape

If the Chinese Government
acquiesce

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acquiesce in their proceedings. There is little to be said by others against them. but I can scarcely suppose that any attempt on the part of the Japanese Govt should succeed jointly with China can be acceptable to the latter. To my mind the Japanese are making a false step: in order to gratify national conceit they are incurring unnecessary expense, and are risking collision with the Chinese, with whom, in my opinion, they are unequal to cope if misunderstanding should culminate in open hostilities.

I have &c &c.

(Sd) Harry Parkes

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Sir C. Robertson
to
Mr. Lowde
—2—

Enclosure
No. 16
in Mr. Lowde's
No. 42
of April 30th 1874

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Hong Kong

6th April 1874

No. 4

Sir.

I have the honor to inform you that being at Hongkong on a visit to Governor Sir Arthur Kennedy I am able to state that His Excellency received on the evening of the 4th Inst. a telegram from Sir Harry Parkes at Yedo to the effect that the Japanese Government had suddenly taken measures to despatch a military force

T. F. Wade Esq. C.B.
&c. &c. &c.

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force in the Fleet at their disposal including some hired transports, their destination being the island of Formosa with the view of Commencing hostilities against the Aborigines (the Chastisement of whom by the Chinese Government for the murder of the crew of a Japanese vessel wrecked on the coast they have some time requested but without avail).

His Excellency communicated this telegram to the admiral Sir Charles Shadwell, who is here, and who told I believe, despatches a man of war to the South East end of Formosa,

where

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where the Japanese Fleet will — rendezvous, & watch proceedings.

I have telegraphed this by the Cable, but being confidential, I am precluded from doing so in words.

I am

&c &c

(Signed) B. Robertson